



## **Cognitive Psychology (COGPSY)**

Module 3: Memory: Encoding, Storage and Retrieval

### **Encoding in Long-Term Memory**

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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## What Is Memory?

Memory is the process that lets us encode, store, and later retrieve information. Long-term memory can hold a large amount of information for a long time. Many students say they have a poor memory. Often the information is still stored, but retrieval fails at that moment.

## Encoding

Encoding means changing information into a form that can be stored. Automatic processing happens with little effort. Effortful processing needs attention and work, which is what most serious study requires.

Semantic encoding focuses on meaning and is usually strongest for exams. Acoustic encoding focuses on sound. Visual encoding focuses on images and layout. Deep processing focuses on meaning, links, and organisation. Shallow processing focuses on surface features only.

## Deep versus Shallow Processing

Deep processing usually creates stronger memory traces. Explaining a concept to a roommate often helps more than rereading the same paragraph five times without understanding.

**Reflect:** *For your hardest course this semester, are you mostly using shallow rereading or deep explanation in your own words?*

## Closing

Encoding sets up storage. The next lesson focuses on retrieval cues, interference, and practical ways to improve recall.